

- MariaDB offers a cluster database for commercial use, which also enables multi-master replication. Anyone can use it freely and reliance on a MySQL Enterprise system is not required.

Cons

- Migration of MariaDB back to MySQL has not been possible since release 5.5.36.
- For new releases of MariaDB, the appropriate libraries (for Debian) will not be deployed in time, which will result in a required upgrade to a newer version due to dependencies.
- Cluster version of MariaDB is not very stable.

Top reasons to migrate to MariaDB

- First and foremost, MariaDB offers more and better storage engines. NoSQL support, provided by Cassandra, allows you to run SQL and NoSQL in a single database system. MariaDB also supports Tokudb, which can handle Big Data for large organisations and corporate users.
- MySQL's usual (and slow) database engines MyISAM and InnoDB have been replaced in MariaDB by Aria and XtraDB respectively. Aria offers better caching, which makes a difference when it comes to disk-intensive operations.

- MariaDB provides better monitoring through the introduction of micro-second precision and extended user statistics.
- The cutting-edge features of MariaDB like GIS, dynamic column support, etc, make it a better choice.
- MariaDB follows good industry standards by releasing security announcements and upgrades at the same time, and handling the pre-release secrecy and post-release transparency in a proper way. 

References

- [1] <https://www.mysql.com/>
- [2] <http://www.oracle.com/technetwork/database/mysql/index.html>
- [3] <https://mariadb.org/>

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